Voucher Route Card Research (India) — Buyer Side

Prepared 5 Nov 2026 for the Voucher Rail buyer engine. Scope: cards and bank portals that give accelerated rewards when a buyer purchases brand gift vouchers. Rule: the engine recommends only what the issuer's official terms allow. Every number must be re-checked against the official source before it is shown to a user.

Source grades

- **OFFICIAL** — read on the bank's own page or PDF.
- **SECONDARY** — reported by a review site that cites the bank; must be confirmed on the official page before going live.
- **PENDING** — not yet researched.

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1. Channel summary

Channel	Bank	What it does for vouchers	Status	Source
SmartBuy (GyFTR / Woohoo vouchers)	HDFC	Accelerated points on brand vouchers; voucher bonus capped at 3,000 RP/month for premium cards since 1 Jul 2026, inside the card's overall SmartBuy cap. InstaDeals excluded from accelerated points.	OFFICIAL (Infinia), SECONDARY (other cards)	SmartBuy offer 15282, LFAL
GyFTR InstaDeals	HDFC partner	Instant discount (e.g. 7.5% Lifestyle) + 1X points. Cannot	OFFICIAL (calculator, 4 Nov 2026)	GyFTR Lifestyle

Channel	Bank	What it does for vouchers	Status	Source
		be combined with accelerated points.		
iShop	ICICI	6X on vouchers and flights, 12X on hotels; per-card monthly bonus caps; separate ₹12,000/month cap on Amazon Pay, Amazon Shopping and Flipkart vouchers.	SECONDARY (data from Feb–Mar 2025 — stale)	CardExpert, iShop
Grab Deals	Axis	No voucher multiplier found. Magnus gift-card purchases earn nothing from 28 Aug 2026.	SECONDARY	PickMyCard, Magnus Burgundy T&C
Reward Multiplier	Amex India	**Ended 30 Sep 2026.** ShopWise e-vouchers still advertised at 5X on 200+ brands.	SECONDARY	LFAL, Amex
Aurum reward portal	SBI	No accelerated earning on buying vouchers; 4 RP per ₹100 standard.	OFFICIAL	SBI Aurum T&C

2. Card table (20 slots)

Reward value assumes the best official redemption (flights/hotels at ₹1 per point unless stated). Multipliers include base points.

#	Card	Best voucher route	Voucher rate	Monthly voucher cap	Status
1	HDFC Infinia	SmartBuy brand vouchers 5X	~16.5% (5 RP/₹150 × 5)	3,000 bonus RP	OFFICIAL
2	HDFC Infinia Metal	SmartBuy 5X	~16.5%	3,000 bonus RP	OFFICIAL (same terms)
3	HDFC Diners Club Black Metal	SmartBuy	multiplier not confirmed	3,000 bonus RP	SECONDARY
4	HDFC Diners Club Black	SmartBuy	multiplier not confirmed	3,000 bonus RP	SECONDARY
5	HDFC BizBlack Metal	SmartBuy	multiplier not confirmed	3,000 bonus RP	SECONDARY
6	HDFC Regalia Gold	SmartBuy	multiplier not confirmed	3,000 bonus RP	SECONDARY
7	ICICI Emeralde Private Metal	iShop 6X	18%	18,000 bonus pts; Amazon/Flipkart vouchers ₹12,000	SECONDARY (stale)
8	ICICI Times Black	iShop 6X	12%	15,000 bonus pts	SECONDARY (stale)
9	ICICI Emeralde	iShop 6X	6%	12,000 bonus pts	SECONDARY (stale)

#	Card	Best voucher route	Voucher rate	Monthly voucher cap	Status
10	ICICI Sapphiro	iShop 6X	3%	9,000 bonus pts	SECONDARY (stale)
11	ICICI Rubyx	iShop 6X	3%	9,000 bonus pts	SECONDARY (stale)
12	ICICI Coral	iShop 6X	3%	9,000 bonus pts	SECONDARY (stale)
13	Amazon Pay ICICI (cashback)	iShop co-brand	4%	₹1,100 cashback	SECONDARY (stale)
14	Axis Magnus	none	0% on gift cards from 28 Aug 2026	—	SECONDARY
15	Axis Magnus for Burgundy	none	0% on gift cards from 28 Aug 2026	—	SECONDARY (official PDF cited)
16	Amex Platinum Charge	ShopWise 5X	depends on MR redemption value	not confirmed	SECONDARY
17	SBI Aurum	none	4 RP/₹100 base only, if vouchers earn at all	—	OFFICIAL
18	SBI Cashback	—	—	—	PENDING
19	Axis Ace / Flipkart Axis (cashback)	—	—	—	PENDING
20	HSBC Premier / IDFC First	—	—	—	PENDING

#	Card	Best voucher route	Voucher rate	Monthly voucher cap	Status
	Wealth / Kotak (pick one)				

Note: Amazon Pay ICICI's 5% (Prime) / 3% rate is for Amazon purchases. Its terms PDF has to be checked for whether gift cards and Amazon Pay balance loads earn. Terms PDF

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3. How the engine chooses (scenarios)

The engine works out, for a voucher request of brand B and amount A:

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None
value = sum over transactions of floor(txn / spend_unit) × base_points ×
multiplier × point_value
        - fees, limited by remaining monthly caps
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then ranks every (card × channel) the buyer holds, and shows why each loser lost.

Scenario	Buyer holds	Request	Engine picks	Why the others lose
A. Bonus available	Infinia	Lifestyle ₹10,000	SmartBuy 5X, 2 × ₹5,000 → 1,650 RP (₹1,650 travel, 16.5%)	InstaDeals 10.5%; direct 3.3%
B. Bonus used up	Infinia, 3,000 bonus RP already earned this month	Lifestyle ₹10,000	InstaDeals 7.5% off + 1X (~10.5%)	5X no longer pays extra after the cap
C. Two premium cards	Infinia + Emeralde Private Metal	Amazon Pay ₹10,000	Compare SmartBuy 5X with iShop 6X	Whichever has less cap left or a lower point value

Scenario	Buyer holds	Request	Engine picks	Why the others lose
			(18%) inside the ₹12,000 iShop Amazon/Flipkart cap — only after both are re-verified	
D. Excluded card	Axis Magnus only	any voucher	Tell the buyer this card earns nothing on gift cards; suggest the best card they hold that does	Magnus gift-card category earns 0
E. Statement-credit user	Infinia, wants cash not travel	Lifestyle ₹10,000	Show value at ₹0.30/RP = ₹495 (4.95%)	Travel value doesn't apply to their redemption choice

Rules the engine always applies:

- Per-transaction rounding (points per ₹150 or ₹200 are rounded down on each voucher).
- Remaining monthly cap, reserved while an order is open.
- Exclusion lists (InstaDeals vs accelerated; Magnus gift-card category; wallet loads).
- Points posting delay (SmartBuy: up to 90 working days) shown as "expected", not "earned".
- Source link and "checked on" date shown with every number.

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4. What this file deliberately leaves out

Ways of earning on vouchers where the issuer's terms say you shouldn't (merchant-code tricks, splitting to dodge caps, routing through wallets) are not included. The engine only recommends routes the bank officially offers, because users who rely on workarounds risk losing points or having their card closed.

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5. Next research steps

1. Confirm rows 3–6 multipliers on the official SmartBuy page.
2. Re-check ICICI iShop (rows 7–13) on the official iShop terms; the data above is from early 2025.
3. Read the Axis Magnus (non-Burgundy) terms for the gift-card clause.
4. Research rows 18–20 from official bank terms.
5. Add the Europe card list once received.